She had reason not to worry, I gave a very successful talk, without notes and without preparation of any kind. It was clear to me that I loved talking in general and that I loved the laughter and applause.

In the euphoria that followed the talk, I let Brad buy me a drink. I also let Fred buy me a drink. Then it was Brad's turn. Well, you're ahead of me. By banquet time I was drunk.

After I had gotten distinctly drunk, I saw Sprague de Camp in the distance, felt overwhelmed with love, called out "Sprague," and ran for him. He looked horrified and left in a hurry. I think he was afraid I would hug him or something, and he may have been right.

At the banquet, while I maintained an uneasy silence and tried to sober up, someone said, "Oh they're taking a picture of us" and so they were, one of those panoramic banquet views.

"Where?" said I, swinging around in my chair and looking at the camera with a vague, drunken stare and the camera snapped. When the picture was developed, there was our table (in the background, fortunately) and there was I, clearly drunk, though too small to notice unless pointed out. 4

The best part of the day to me, though, was listening to Lester del Rey's speech in which he lambasted dianetics very rationally and without stint. Campbell was not in the audience, I noted.

Horace Gold called me the next day and talked me into promising to do another story for him. On the train back, on July 4, I started one that I called "Potent Stuff," using nothing more than pen and ink.

4 A year later, Life did an article on science fiction in which this banquet picture was featured. How embarrassing that the only time my face ever appeared in Life it was a drunken face.

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On July 6, I had my last driving lesson, and on July 7, I took my driving test. I thought I did very well, but the testers are in a position that appeals to all the latent sadism in one. The people taking the test are invariably frightened, tense, and pitifully anxious to please. Naturally, any person with talents sufficiently small to make it necessary for him to make a living testing drivers can't resist that.